RAS: ICP and Buyer Personas

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1. What we are selling

RAS produces the work of a research, analysis and strategy team: it fuses a company's internal data, cited external research and quantitative analysis into a single print-grade, auditable strategy artifact. Every artifact is reproducible, diffable and forkable through event-sourced memory, an adversarial reviewer sits in the pipeline, and a doctrine engine learns the firm's own methodology so the output follows their rules, not generic ones. The closest competitors, AlphaSense and Hebbia, each cover a slice of this. Neither closes the loop.

The buyer, therefore, is any company whose decisions and products run on evidence, and whose research capacity is the bottleneck.

2. Geography

India first, US second. Europe is a possible third. Asia Pacific is out.

3. The ICP definition

A qualified RAS account has all five of these properties:

1. The company's core decisions (credit, investment, coverage, pipeline, market entry) depend on research and analysis.
2. Analyst or researcher capacity is a visible constraint: coverage they cannot expand, diligence that queues, reports that take weeks.
3. It is regulated, or answers to an investment committee, board or regulator, which makes auditability and citation a feature rather than a nice-to-have.
4. Leadership is reachable and can commit without a formal procurement cycle. This is the muscle test. If entry requires a twelve month vendor onboarding process, the account moves to the partner-led list regardless of fit.
5. It is in India or the US.

4. Target segments

Segment	What they look like	The pain	What RAS gives them
NBFCs (digital lending companies)	Tech-forward lenders in India: consumer, MSME, vehicle, gold, embedded credit	Credit strategy, portfolio and market analysis run slower than the loan book grows; every analysis must survive an RBI conversation	Loan-book questions answered in natural language, portfolio and market analysis as auditable artifacts, a regulator-ready trail behind every number
Fintechs	Payments, credit infrastructure, wealth tech, insurtech, in India and the US	Board-grade and regulator-grade analysis needed constantly, no research team on the payroll	Market research, competitive analysis and internal metrics fused into one cited document the board and the regulator both accept
Mutual fund companies (AMCs)	Asset managers where analyst coverage defines the product	Each analyst covers a limited universe; expanding coverage means expanding headcount; compliance reviews everything	More coverage per analyst, cited and reproducible research notes, methodology consistency enforced by the doctrine engine
Equity research companies	Sell-side boutiques and independent research firms	Revenue is literally reports per analyst per month; initiation reports take weeks	Faster initiations and updates, house methodology applied uniformly, every claim cited and checkable
Credit bureaus	Data businesses under heavy regulatory scrutiny	Analytics R&D on massive sensitive datasets, with data that cannot leave the building	Natural-language analysis over their own data estate, deployable on-prem or air-gapped, with a full audit trail

Segment	What they look like	The pain	What RAS gives them
Credit rating agencies	Their entire product is evidence-backed judgement defensible to a regulator	Rating rationale must be consistent, reproducible and explainable across analysts	Doctrine engine encodes the rating methodology; every rationale is reproducible, diffable and defensible
Debt and credit processing companies	Servicers, collections platforms, securitisation and credit ops firms	Exposure, recovery and pricing decisions run on data they cannot query fast enough	Loan-level data plus market research plus quantitative analysis in one auditable artifact
BFSI, excluding large banks	Insurance, broking, wealth managers, small finance banks	Analytically hungry, regulated, larger data estates	Deployment-agnostic analysis across SaaS, BYOC, on-prem and air-gapped, with ESM reproducibility for the compliance conversation
Life sciences and pharma startups	Biotech and life sciences startups, including the ones already in conversation	Small teams making very expensive decisions on incomplete evidence; no research bench	A research and strategy function without the headcount, powered by the life sciences vertical skill pack
VC funds	Early to growth stage funds	Diligence throughput is the bottleneck on deals seen versus deals done	Compressed diligence, IC-grade memos, continuous portfolio monitoring, via the PE and VC vertical skill pack
Private equity firms	Buyout and growth firms	Thesis work, diligence and portfolio value	Print-grade strategy documents an investment committee accepts,

Segment	What they look like	The pain	What RAS gives them
		creation are all evidence-heavy	with firm-specific rules accumulating in the doctrine engine

5. The ABM persona map

The pattern across every segment is the same. The person who touches RAS daily, the researcher, the scientist, the analyst, usually has little say in procurement. The influencer is the CIO or COO type: senior, tech-savvy, measured on whether the business succeeds, and actively looking for leverage. The decision maker depends on the size of the company: the CEO in most of this list, sometimes the CTO, and in some cases the board.

One title warning for financial services: CIO means two different people. In an AMC, the Chief Investment Officer owns the research output and is often the strongest influencer, while the Chief Information or Technology Officer is the gatekeeper on deployment and data. Both must be mapped in the same account.

Segment	User (daily)	Influencer	Decision maker	Blocker to watch
NBFC digital lending	Credit analysts, risk analysts, collections strategy	Chief Risk Officer, CIO, COO	MD or CEO	Compliance (RBI lens), infosec
Fintech	Strategy and analytics leads, product analysts	CTO, COO	Founder or CEO	Data security review
Mutual fund (AMC)	Research analysts, fund managers	Chief Investment Officer, COO; CTO as gatekeeper	CEO or MD; board or trustees in larger AMCs	Compliance (SEBI lens), infosec
Equity research	Research analysts	Head of Research	Founder, CEO or partners; in boutiques the Head of Research often decides	Cost per seat versus analyst salary math

Segment	User (daily)	Influencer	Decision maker	Blocker to watch
Credit bureau	Data science and analytics teams	Chief Data Officer, CTO	CEO; board where regulatory exposure is high	Data governance, regulator scrutiny, security review
Credit rating agency	Rating analysts	Chief Ratings Officer or Head of Analytics, CIO	CEO or MD	Methodology committee, compliance
Debt and credit processing	Portfolio and recovery analysts	COO, CIO	CEO	Client data confidentiality clauses
BFSI ex large banks	Analysts, actuaries, strategy teams	CIO, CDO, COO	CEO	IT risk, model risk, compliance
Life sciences startup	Scientists, researchers, medical affairs, BD	COO, Head of R&D strategy, CIO where one exists	Founder or CEO; the board in VC-backed biotechs for platform spend	IP confidentiality, QA and regulatory mindset
VC fund	Associates and analysts	Principals, platform or operations partner	GP, managing partner, or the partnership	Confidentiality of deal flow
Private equity	Deal team associates	Operating partners, principals	Managing partner or investment committee	IC process conservatism

6. Entry point by company size

Startup (under roughly 50 people). Go straight to the founder or CEO. The user and the influencer sit one desk away, and the sale is a single conversation followed by a pilot artifact.

Mid-size (roughly 50 to 500). Enter through the influencer, the CIO, COO, CRO or Chief Investment Officer, because the CEO will turn to exactly that person and ask "does this work". Win the influencer with a pilot on their own data, then let them carry it to the CEO.

Larger regulated institutions. The decision moves to committees and boards, procurement and due diligence get long, and we do not have the sales muscle to staff that cycle. These accounts are partner-led only.

7. Anti-targets and partner routes

Large banks, large pharma and governments are explicitly not direct targets. The reason is capacity, not fit: their procurement and due diligence cycles need salespeople we do not have. If a partner owns the relationship and can close, we are happy to serve the account. Cognizant Life Sciences is the natural route into large pharma. Ecosystem partners are the route into government.

In direct GTM these names work as credibility: global banks including Goldman Sachs and BlackRock already use it, pharma uses it for drug creation, governments use it for departmental and financial management. Cite them. Do not chase them.

8. Qualification checklist

1. Do their core decisions run on research, analysis or evidence?
2. Is analyst or researcher capacity a visible constraint today?
3. Does a regulator, board or investment committee review their work?
4. Can we reach the CEO, or the CIO or COO who has the CEO's ear, without a formal procurement cycle?
5. Is the account in India or the US?
6. Is it a large bank, large pharma company or government? If yes, route to partners or park as credibility.